



Bihar championing the nation's e-sports revolution

Among Bihar's success in the sporting space is its championing of esports, with the State has also keen on hosting the first national games for esports.

While esports' legitimacy as a sport has often been questioned due to its lack of physical activity, NODWIN Gaming Co-Founder Akshat Rathee cleared the air. "Sports, as defined by the International Olympic Committee, is the pursuit of 'Citius, Altius, Fortius' (faster, higher, stronger). When you play a videogame on a smartphone, on a professional level, I am just faster than you. That is why it is a sport. I will kick the ball faster than you, I will shoot a bullet faster than you, I will jump faster than you, I will respond faster than you," he explained.

"Individual esports in India has a lot of money. Esports in India has more than 250 people who earn more than one lakh rupees a month. I think building the grassroots

is a discovery problem and not a 'build' problem. The opportunities are now about States going ahead and taking leadership to its constituents," Rathee said during the panel discussion, moderated by Abhishek Issar, Co-Founder of Federation of Esports India.

Nishi Kant, Chief of Design & Product at JetSynthesys, outlined his vision for promoting the Indian narrative in the esports scene. "Real Cricket is a true indigenous made in India game. All the e-cricket players, who currently play Real Cricket, the next big stage for them is GEPL - Global E-Cricket Premier League, which is the largest esports platform for e-cricketers. We will love to host a GEPL leg here in Bihar with the support of Bihar government and find and scout the best e-cricketing talent and put them on a global stage," he said.

"Cricket is the biggest sport in India. I want to see the best e-cricketer from India, from Bihar, who can come up and play in the GEPL," he added.



From left: Abhishek Issar (founder, UNIV Sportatech & Co-founder, Federation of Esports India), Akshat Rathee (Co-founder NODWIN Gaming), and Nishi Kant (Chief, Design & Product at JetSynthesys) emphasise the growing popularity of e-sports in India. R. V. MOORTHY